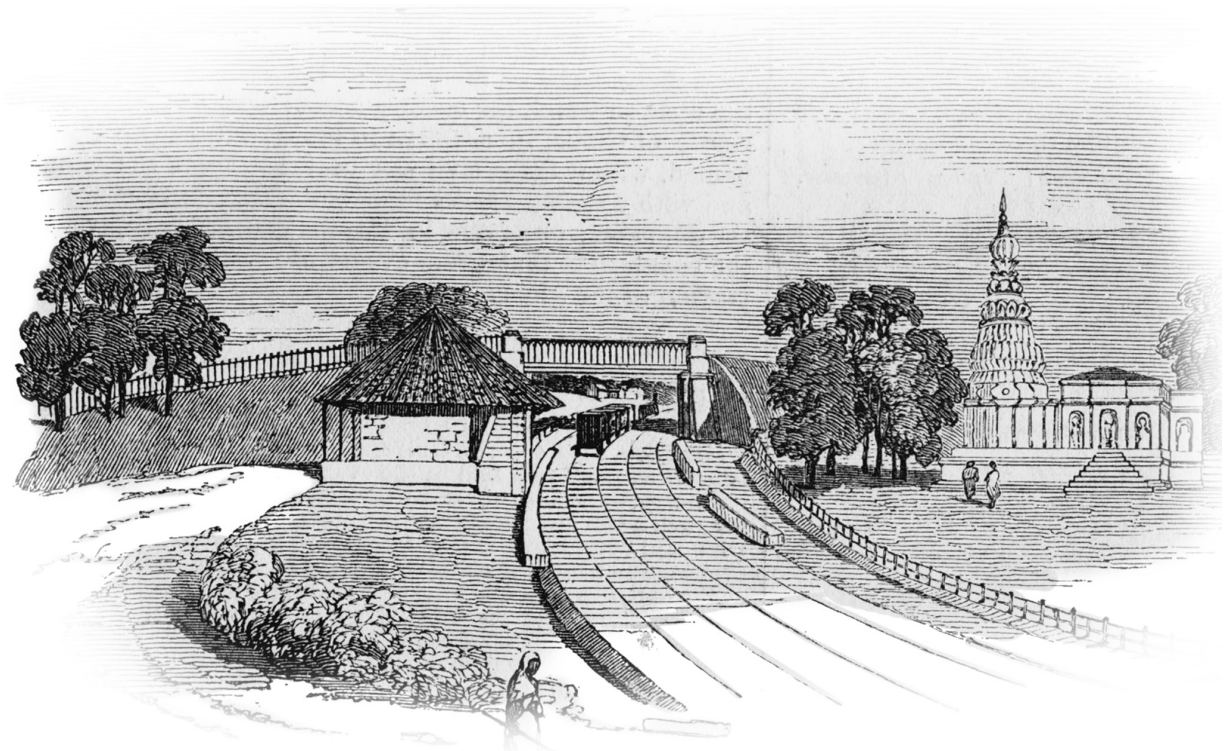


EARLY STATIONS

Small and often dreary, the first stations were designed and built for efficient British rule and easy mobility of resources. With these two principal concerns in mind, the stations favoured functional designs and simplicity over excessive ornamentation. Over the next few decades, however, these stations would transform into elaborate edifices, a visible testament to colonial power.



▲ **The original Byculla station** in Bombay was one of the stops on the Bori Bunder–Thana line. It was initially a simple wooden structure with a bridge. By 1891, it was rebuilt and moved to its present-day location.

Around 1910, a dissatisfied European traveller passing through Wadi Junction in Hyderabad commented: “of all the dreary stations in this land, Wadi is the dreariest.” Perhaps, for his sake, it is fortunate that he